



Cabinet

Title: Improving Wandsworth's housing services

Paper No. 26-15

Date: 26 January 2026

Cabinet Member for: Housing

Details of Executive Director: Paul Chadwick, Executive Director of Resident Services

1. Executive Summary

- 1.1. Following the inspection of housing services a detailed action plan has been developed which addresses the immediate areas for improvement identified by the Regulator and the longer-term transformation of housing into a high-quality service, better able to meet the needs of its tenants.
- 1.2. The immediate actions were agreed with the Regulator, with progress monitored via monthly meetings. Since the Regulatory Judgement was published in February:
 - A rolling programme of stock condition surveys has commenced and since May 2025, 3,392 surveys have been completed.
 - Considerable progress has been made with the programme of electrical safety tests. Approximately 87% of homes and 94% of communal spaces have a satisfactory Electrical Installation Condition Report.
 - Outstanding remedial actions from Fire Risk Assessments has reduced from 1,800 at the time of inspection to 326.
 - The number of overdue repairs has decreased from 2,800 to 1,500.
- 1.3. Extra capacity has been focussed on repairs with the Council's Delivery Unit undertaking a review of the repairs process.
- 1.4. It was also recognised that as well as procedural changes, a cultural change was required to transform the way services are delivered to

tenants and leaseholders. The Council took the decision to merge the Housing Department with Environment and Community Services to create a dedicated Resident Services directorate with recommendations to rationalise the way services are delivered in this area and make efficiencies. A key focus is to increase collaboration amongst all community-facing services to maximise the impact they have.

- 1.5. To that end, a Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan (HIT Plan) has been developed (see Appendix One) which addresses the recommendations from both activities as well as reflecting the transformation that is required to create the new Resident Services directorate in which there will be a housing management service that is fit for purpose and breaks down historic silos. This plan looks to transform services to ensure they are leading edge, put tenants and leaseholders at the heart of all we do and address decades of underinvestment in key services such as health and safety. These changes will also mean the Council is better placed to meet present and future regulatory requirements across all consumer standards.
- 1.6. An experienced interim Director of Housing Management was appointed in November to oversee these necessary changes.
- 1.7. Whilst the longer-term transformation plan is for agreement by Cabinet, the following have already been implemented:
 - Allocation of additional capacity – Director of Business Improvement seconded to support the programme improvements.
 - Cross-party member task and finish group established in September to review and scrutinise key areas of delivery, with recommendations being reported in January 2026.
 - Delivery Unit overseeing a review of the repairs service, working in partnership with senior housing managers.

2. Recommendation/s:

- 2.1. Agree the Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan (Appendix One).

- 2.2. Support the creation of a Housing Improvement and Transformation Board, chaired by an independent, expert Chair.

Responding to the Regulatory Judgement

- 2.3. Over the past ten years the requirements of social housing providers have changed significantly, primarily being driven by the Grenfell Tower fire in 2017. All social housing providers are having to adjust their service models to address new legislative environments which are:
- Increased powers of the Regulator of Social Housing and the Housing Ombudsman, and the introduction of the Building Safety Regulator.
 - Greater emphasis on health and safety responsibilities of social landlords.
 - Greater emphasis on having accurate and timely data in relation to managed stock.
 - Introduction of new legislation through Awaab's Law relating to the management and treatment of damp and mould.
 - An emerging requirement to deliver a reduction in carbon emissions which will involve significant retrofit programmes and is being combined into a new Decent Homes Standard.
- 2.4. In February 2025, the Regulator of Social Housing issued Wandsworth with a C3 regulatory judgement [see Paper No. 25-133]. This judgement reflects serious failings in delivering the consumer standards introduced by the Regulator in April 2023. The principal areas found for improvement relate to the Safety and Quality Standard, specifically noted by the Regulator were:
- A lack of up-to-date information on the condition of homes managed.
 - Incomplete programme of electrical safety checks.
 - 1,800 fire remedial actions overdue.
- 2.5. The Regulator also recommended improvements in the Transparency, Influence and Accountability Standard. While it was noted the Council had a well-established formal framework for engagement with tenants, there was a need to provide further informal routes and improve tenant-led engagement. It is both the Safety and Quality and Transparency,

Influence and Accountability standards that have informed much of the Council's work throughout 2025.

- 2.6. Since the judgement was issued, monthly meetings are being held with the Regulator to review progress. These are attended by the Executive Director of Resident Services and senior Housing managers and representatives from the Regulator. Meetings include detailed, data-informed presentations, principally on the Safety and Quality Standard but also Transparency, Influence and Accountability.
- 2.7. At the November meeting, which included the Chief Executive, the Regulator noted the positive progress made since the inspection but emphasised the need to keep pace of delivery and prove impact.
- 2.8. Since the Regulatory Judgement was issued in February 2025, the following actions have been delivered:
 - Appointment of an experienced interim Director of Housing Management to oversee compliance with regulatory standards.
 - New monitoring framework adopted to ensure greater oversight and scrutiny of housing performance.
 - Progress in Electrical Installation Condition Report (EICR) programme delivery: approximately 87% of homes and 94% of communal spaces now have a satisfactory EICR.
 - Reduction in overdue remedial fire safety actions from 1,800 to 326.
 - Commencement of a programme of stock condition surveys with over 3,300 completed to date, this has been accelerated to be completed by December 2026.
 - Working with the Corporate Delivery Unit to change the way repairs are reported and actioned.
 - Recruitment of a Resident Participation Manager with more avenues for tenant engagement implemented.
- 2.9. Actions that will be delivered over the next twelve months to address the areas for improvement, found by the Regulator, are set out in Appendix One.

Transformation of Housing

- 2.10. Whilst we are well placed to respond to the issues found by the Regulator, longer-term, transformational changes were also identified as part of a Root Cause Analysis (see Appendix Two) which has been used to inform the HIT Plan. This analysis highlighted a series of structural and cultural challenges that need to be addressed for us to fulfil our ambition of providing a high-quality housing service. A root cause analysis is an expectation of the Regulator for all authorities that do not meet the consumer standards.
- 2.11. The analysis found a significant history of stagnation in the management of council housing in Wandsworth with limited appetite for change and innovation. Over time, this created a service which - when reviewed in the current operating environment of the Regulator of Social Housing, Building Safety Regulator and the Housing Ombudsman - was out of touch.
- 2.12. The new regulatory regime requires all social housing providers to annually report satisfaction measures to the Regulator. Attached at Appendix Three is a report which sets out Wandsworth's position for the year ending 31st March 2025. It is clear from that report that there are areas of weakness that need to be addressed and so the Tenant Satisfaction Measures will form a key part of our monitoring the impact of our improvements on our tenants. To support this, we have also re-engaged with Housemark, a benchmarking service, which will enable us to compare our service delivery, performance and value for money efficiency against peers.
- 2.13. The primary factor found by the Regulator was that the Council had lost sight of the customer from a health and safety and involvement perspective. The key issues that prevented us from achieving the expected outcome from the inspection were:
- The position of Housing: its relationship with the wider council and how issues were addressed.
 - A siloed departmental culture characterised by entrenched ways of working, lack of strategic focus, and centralised decision-making.
 - Data and systems that sometimes conflicted, were difficult to access, and the housing management system was not fully utilised.
 - Performance issues, including underperformance not being effectively addressed and insufficient use of data and insight to drive

improvement.

- 2.14. Each of these root causes, and associated symptoms, have been mapped to a series of actions included within the HIT Plan.
- 2.15. The HIT Plan has been developed following feedback from the Regulator on the relevant areas of focus.
- 2.16. It is a high-level action plan that focuses on the efforts undertaken to meet both the Safety and Quality and Transparency, Influence and Accountability standards. In addition, it incorporates the Council's transformation commitments: these are the structural changes that need to be achieved to drive sustainable improvements over the longer-term.
- 2.17. Operationally, all project owners must manage and maintain trackers that outline the delivery of their workstreams.

Monitoring framework

- 2.18. It is proposed that a Housing Improvement and Transformation Board will be at the heart of the new monitoring framework. Central to this is the role of an independent Chair - an expert within the sector - able to hold the Council to account, oversee implementation of the HIT Plan and share insight and awareness of best practice within the sector.
- 2.19. It is proposed that the Housing Improvement and Transformation Board meets on a quarterly basis.
- 2.20. As well as an external Chair, its membership is proposed to consist of: the Cabinet Member for Housing, two members from the cross-party task and finish group, two tenant representatives, two Executive Directors from outside the service, the Executive Director of Resident Services and the Director of Housing Management. Other invitees or expansion of the membership would be agreed by the Board.
- 2.21. The Board will be responsible for ensuring that all actions included within the HIT Plan are being delivered and will receive progress reports ahead of each meeting. The Board will make recommendations to senior management and is able to request detailed information

pertaining to any of the actions included within the plan.

- 2.22. Prior to the Board's formation, we will undertake to identify a suitable independent Chair with demonstrable experience within the housing sector.

3. Future challenges

- 3.1. For context, it is important to recognise that in the post-Grenfell space the regulatory requirement of social landlords and its duties have expanded significantly. This was set out in the 58 recommendations arising from the Grenfell Inquiry. These placed expanded statutory duties, higher compliance standards and greater accountability on landlords.
- 3.2. Most social landlords began responding to this changing environment after the Social Housing White Paper (2020) by investing in and enhancing their housing and building safety teams, investing in competence and systems and embedding resident engagement at the core of service delivery.
- 3.3. Wandsworth did not significantly change its practices following the White Paper. This failure to adapt meant that Wandsworth was not managing its stock in compliance with the consumer standards set by the Regulator of Social Housing, particularly when it came to stock condition data. Consequently, when the inspection started in November 2024 and completed in February 2025, the services were found non-compliant and resulted in regulatory intervention and reputational damage.
- 3.4. The HIT Plan sets out actions that must be delivered over the next 36 months to move the Council to a position of compliance which will ensure it provides safe homes for its tenants.
- 3.5. The start of that process will focus the Council's attention in 2026/27 on the following specific areas:

Understanding stock data and condition

- 3.6. The Council has now committed to an accelerated programme of stock condition surveys to tenanted homes to achieve 100% by December 2026. This work is progressing well with initial targets being surpassed which provides confidence that the 100% surveys will be completed on time. These surveys include an assessment using the Housing Health and Safety Rating System (HHSRS). Surveys will ensure we have a full understanding of the condition of our homes, can react quickly to any safety concerns and can add necessary works into the capital programme. From the 1st April 2027, we will commence a five-year re-survey programme with 20% of stock being surveyed each year to ensure information remains fit for purpose for investment.

3.7.

Improving the repairs service

- 3.8. Tenants and leaseholders have told us that the repairs service needs to improve. Whilst not recognised as an area of serious failing by the Regulator, we are committed to responding to this and are prioritising sustained changes to the service. This will involve redesigning the service, increasing the use of digital platforms used to log repairs and simplifying processes. Satisfaction levels with the repairs service remain low (58%) when compared to similar landlords in London (65%). Since August, officers from Housing have been collaborating closely with the Council's Delivery Unit to better understand where challenges are, including processes for reporting and undertaking repairs.

Understanding vulnerable households

- 3.9. Considerable progress has been made since the publication of the Vulnerable Households Policy in November 2024. Building on this foundation, a comprehensive audit of data on vulnerable households is scheduled for 2026. This audit will strengthen our understanding of residents' needs and support the development of Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans for those living in high-rise buildings. It will also enable more tailored engagement and service delivery, ensuring that

support is responsive and effective.

Increasing participation and engagement

- 3.10. Strong progress has been achieved in strengthening the 'tenant voice', and further enhancements are underway. In their inspection, the Regulator emphasised the need for more opportunities for tenant-led engagement. The Council is responding proactively. The Participation Register has been significantly expanded and now includes over 700 residents (of which, 500 are tenants), demonstrating growing interest and involvement. A comprehensive engagement calendar for 2026 is in development and will be refreshed throughout the year to maintain momentum. In addition, an audit of the Council's resident participation structures will be commissioned early in the new year to ensure these arrangements remain effective and inclusive.

Achieving health and safety compliance

- 3.11. To ensure the Council meets its statutory health and safety obligations and provides assurance to its tenants and the Regulator, we have undertaken a desktop assessment of existing staffing and budget resources and identified two key points.
- 3.12. Firstly, the existing compliance staff are shared across the width of the Housing Management service, creating a disjointed service model which is not coordinating its abilities or resources to deliver existing services.
- 3.13. Secondly, there are additional responsibilities arising from the Building Safety Act (2022) which has a particular focus on the management and maintenance of high-rise buildings. The Council has 148 high-rise buildings, and needs to increase its staffing capacity to undertake the work.
- 3.14. By establishing and investing in a dedicated team, the Council will be better resourced to ensure ongoing compliance across its housing stock, mitigate risk, and avoid the financial and reputational consequences of non-compliance.
- 3.15. This will provide further assurance to both the Regulator of Social Housing and the Building Safety Regulator, ensuring that the Safety

and Quality standard is fully met. It should be noted that this team will be managing an annual budget of approximately £16 million excluding major capital programmes (which they will also lead).

- 3.16. A single team will be more efficient and effective and will provide better value for money through the avoidance of duplication. Once embedded, this will positively impact the activities of frontline housing management staff, enabling improvements in service as well as efficiencies in operational staffing levels.
- 3.17. For tenants, this means greater assurance that homes are safe, well-maintained and compliant with all building safety standards. It will also lead to improved communications and swifter resolutions, with accurate stock data being acted on in a timely manner.

4. Cabinet Member Comments

- 4.1. This improvement plan marks the end of the old era and the beginning of new chapter in how Wandsworth operates as a social landlord. Bringing our responsibilities and systems as a housing provider up to the modern standards that our tenants expect and deserve.
- 4.2. For decades the previous administration championed the 'Wandsworth way', but what we have found is that many of the corporate systems and models that we have inherited were not fit for the new regulatory environment and standards that social housing providers are expected to meet.
- 4.3. For years we were told how impressive the Council's 100% decent homes standard was, but what good is a 100% decent homes rating if it is based on a stock condition survey of only 1% of our homes? This plan will help us understand our stock fully, what work needs to be done, and help us prepare for the future.
- 4.4. This improvement plan will put us on the road to delivering the best service for our tenants and crucially putting their voices and experience at the centre of our decision making.

5. Financial Implications



- 5.1. There is a need to invest in both the Council's services and the stock itself to deliver improvements within the Housing Improvement Plan. As the development of the HIT Plan continues, the level of investment required will be further refined. Reflecting the need to increase staffing capacity, revenue budget growth of £1.5m has been incorporated into the Housing Revenue Account budget and business plan from 2026/27 as part of the current budget setting process which is reported elsewhere on the Cabinet agenda.

6. Legal Implications

- 6.1 This paper has been reviewed by Legal and there are no comments at this time.

7. Conclusion

- 7.1. A significant programme of work has been delivered since the Regulatory Judgement was issued to the Council in February 2025. We will continue our efforts to ensure that Wandsworth's homes are safe, secure and professionally managed. Further investment in the service is much needed and will give greater confidence to the Council in how it ensures the safety and quality of our homes. This will give peace of mind to tenants and provide necessary assurance to both the Regulator of Social Housing and the Building Safety Regulator.
- 7.2. Improvements will continue throughout 2026. These improvements will be closely monitored by a newly established board, ensuring that senior officers are accountable for implementing agreed changes and delivering a high-quality landlord service to our residents.

8. Reference to any accompanying papers:

Appendix One – Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan
Appendix Two – Root Cause Analysis
Appendix Three – Tenant Satisfaction Measures (2024-25 performance)

9. Background Papers



Regulator of Social Housing: Regulatory Judgement for London Borough of
Wandsworth: [26 February 2025 - GOV.UK](#)



HOUSING IMPROVEMENT AND TRANSFORMATION PLAN

Ref	Topic	Activity	Timescale	BRAG
#	Meeting the safety and quality standard			
1	Fire safety	Reduce outstanding FRA actions	Q3 2025-26	
2	Fire safety	Complete the catch-up programme of front door inspections	Q4 2025-26	
3	Fire safety	Develop an annual programme for future years' front door inspections	Q4 2025-26	
4	Health and safety	Complete the catch-up programme for domestic EICRs	Q4 2025-26	
5	Health and safety	Complete the catch-up programme for communal EICRs	Q3 2025-26	
6	Health and safety	Develop a five-year programme for domestic and communal EICRs	Q4 2025-26	
7	Health and safety	Achieve full compliance with smoke alarm/detectors installations	Q4 2025-26	
8	Health and safety	Commission third party audit of health and safety functions	Q4 2025-26	
9	Health and safety	Implement findings from third party health and safety audit	TBC	
10	Health and safety	Create Compliance Team	Q2 2026-27	
11	Damp and mould	Provide assurance to Councillors regarding damp and mould reporting	Q3 2025-26	
12	Stock quality	Complete programme of stock condition surveys by end of 2026	Q3 2026-27	
13	Stock quality	Develop a rolling programme of stock condition surveys	Q4 2026-27	
14	Capital programming	Develop a new Asset Management Strategy built upon stock condition data and current industry practice on asset investment	Q4 2026-27	
15	Capital programming	Develop a new five-year capital investment plan	Q4 2026-27	
16	Capital programming	Through robust procurement, appoint strategic capital programme delivery contractors	Q4 2026-27	
17	Repairs	Achieve 'business as usual target' for repairs orders over target: reduce to <1% repairs over target (routine or standard only)	Q4 2025-26	
18	Repairs	Complete Delivery Unit review of repairs service	Q4 2025-26	
19	Repairs	Implement recommendations from repairs review	Q1 2027-28	
#	Meeting the Transparency, Influence and Accountability standard			
20	Complaints	Improve complaints handling that includes response times, learning from maladministration and reduced maladministration rates.	Q4 2026-27	
21	Transparency	Communicate to tenants the outcomes of the regulatory inspection	Completed	
22	Transparency	Increase opportunities for senior management and councillors to review performance information	Completed	
23	Resident engagement	Establish two focus groups with residents who have taken part in the Perception Survey and from the Participation Register	Completed	
24	Resident engagement	Commission third party review of resident engagement	Q4 2025-26	
25	Resident engagement	Implement findings from third party review of resident engagement	TBC	
26	Vulnerable residents	Conclude Phase Two of vulnerabilities work.	Q4 2025-26	
#	Transforming housing services			
27	Structure and services	Communicate to staff the outcomes of the regulatory inspection	Completed	
28	Structure and services	Restructure senior management to two director roles	Completed	
29	Structure and services	Appoint new senior management to lead the response to the regulatory inspection	Completed	
30	Structure and services	Review of Business Support and Finance functions	Q2 2026-27	
31	Structure and services	Restructure of Housing	Q2 2027-28	
32	Technology	Review and improve the use of data and technology to inform services to tenants	Q2 2026-27	

On track

In progress

Slippage

Completed

Not yet commenced

HOUSING IMPROVEMENT AND TRANSFORMATION PLAN

Ref	Topic	Required action/s	Officer lead(s)	Completion date	Risks to tenants if action not fulfilled	BRAG	Outputs	Target
Meeting the Safety and Quality standard								
1	Fire safety	Reduce outstanding FRA actions	Tom Crawley	Q4 2025-26	Risk of harm if FRAs actions not completed in time.		Full FRA compliance	0
2	Fire safety	Complete the catch-up programme of front door inspections	Tom Crawley	Q4 2025-26	Risk of harm, delayed escape, or reduced protection in the event of a fire if doors are non-compliant.		Fully compliant front doors across our stock	100% p/a
3	Fire safety	Develop an annual programme for future years' front door inspections	Tom Crawley	Q4 2025-26	Risk of harm, delayed escape, or reduced protection in the event of a fire if doors are non-compliant.		Fully resourced and managed programme of front door inspections	100% p/a
4	Health and safety	Complete the catch-up programme for domestic EICRs	Sharron Lecky	Q1 2026-27	Risk of electrical shock and risk to fire safety of tenant and neighbouring properties.		Full EICR compliance	100%
5	Health and safety	Complete the catch-up programme for communal EICRs	Sharron Lecky	Q3 2025-26	Risk of electrical shock and risk to fire safety to residents.		Full EICR compliance	100%
6	Health and safety	Develop a five-year programme for domestic and communal EICRs	Sharron Lecky	Q4 2025-26	Risk of electrical shock and risk to fire safety of tenant and neighbouring properties.		Full EICR compliance	20% p/a
7	Health and safety	Achieve full compliance with smoke alarm/detectors installations.	Tom Crawley	Q4 2025-26	Risk to tenant of fire and smoke inhalation. Any delays in installation due to access issues or resident unavailability could prolong exposure to risk.		Agreed position on no-access properties	100%
8	Health and safety	Commission third party audit of health and safety functions	Kay Willman	Q4 2025-26	Unsafe living conditions if key information is not captured.		External view on the quality of data the Council including gap analysis and recommendations	N/A
9	Health and safety	Implement the findings of health and safety audit	Kay Willman	TBC	Delays in repairs, likelihood of disrepair unsafe living conditions poor allocation of resources.		Improved confidence in health and safety compliance activities	N/A
10	Health and safety	Create Compliance Team	Kay Willman	Q2 2026-27	Risk of tenants living in unsafe homes due to missed hazards and regulatory breaches.		Fully resourced team to oversee health and safety compliance and monitor asset data	N/A

Ref	Topic	Required action/s	Officer lead(s)	Completion date	Risks to tenants if action not fulfilled	BRAG	Outputs	Target
11	Damp and mould	Provide assurance to Councillors regarding damp and mould reporting.	Tom Crawley	Q3 2025-26	Respiratory illness and other health problems for tenants if damp and mould is not tackled within agreed timeframes.		Damp and mould dashboard for tracking live cases	Quarterly
12	Stock quality	Complete programme of stock condition surveys by end of 2026	Kay Willman	Q3 2026-27	Increased risk of living in homes with undetected hazards or disrepair.		Stock condition surveys for all tenanted homes and blocks	100%
13	Stock quality	Develop a rolling programme of stock condition surveys	Kay Willman	Q4 2026-27	Out of date information on tenants' homes; increased likelihood of tenants living with hidden defects or in unsafe conditions.		Stock condition surveys for all tenanted homes and blocks	20% p/a
14	Capital programming	Develop a new Asset Management Strategy built upon stock condition data and current industry practice on asset investment	Kay Willman	Q4 2026-27	Defects, disrepair and worsening living conditions.		A new Asset Management Strategy that incorporates information from stock condition surveys and identifies investment needs and prioritisation of works	N/A
15	Capital programming	Develop a new five-year capital investment plan	Sharron Lecky	Q4 2026-27	Potential lack of delivery or value for money.		A clear investment programme which can be communicated to residents	N/A
16	Capital programming	Through robust procurement, appoint strategic capital programme delivery contractors	Sharron Lecky	Q4 2026-27	Lack of value for money, inefficiency of working practices and resilience of contractors.		Resilience in delivery, improved contract management, higher levels of customer satisfaction	TBC
17	Repairs	Achieve 'business as usual target' for repairs orders over target	Tom Crawley	Q4 2025-26	Defects, disrepair and worsening living conditions.		Minimal number of works being overdue at any one time.	<1% repairs over target (routine or standard only)
18	Repairs	Complete Delivery Unit review of repairs service	Tom Crawley	Q4 2025-26	Repairs not responded to in time or satisfactorily.		Recommendations made to senior managers and members on improving the repairs process	N/A
19	Repairs	Implement recommendations from repairs review	Tom Crawley	Q1 2027-28	Repairs not responded to in time or satisfactorily.		Improvement in tenant satisfaction	TBC
Meeting the Transparency, Influence and Accountability standard								
20	Complaints	Improve complaints handling that includes response times, learning from maladministration and reduced maladministration rates.	Tom Crawley / Kay Willman	Q4 2026-27	Complaints not responded to correctly, within agreed timescales, or satisfactorily. Delays to tenants in successful resolution.		More complaints resolved at first point of contact and a reduction in escalations to Stage 2 and Ombudsman.	<30% (conversion rate from Stage 1 to Stage 2)
21	Transparency	Increase opportunities for senior management and councillors to review performance information	Kay Willman	Completed	Scrutiny of performance particularly in areas of safety and quality enable greater focus on		New governance arrangements established;	N/A

Ref	Topic	Required action/s	Officer lead(s)	Completion date	Risks to tenants if action not fulfilled	BRAG	Outputs	Target
					actions required to ensure our homes are compliant.		improved performance reports for internal and external audiences	
22	Transparency	Communicate to tenants the outcomes of the regulatory inspection	Kay Willman	Completed	Tenant dissatisfaction with opportunities to be involved in the management of their homes.		Improved satisfaction in relation to opportunities to be involved.	TBC
23	Resident engagement	Establish two focus groups with residents who have taken part in the Perception Survey and from the Participation Register	Tom Crawley	Completed	Resident voice is not heard and changes to service(s) do not reflect their experiences.		Short, medium, and long-term actions to be completed by March 2026.	N/A
24	Resident engagement	Commission third party review of resident engagement	Tom Crawley / Kay Willman	Q4 2025-26	Diverse resident voices may not be heard; residents unable to contribute to estate-based improvements or strategic housing decisions.		Recommendation for improved tenant involvement	N/A
25	Resident engagement	Implement findings from review of resident engagement.	Tom Crawley / Kay Willman	TBC	Diverse resident voices may not be heard; residents unable to contribute to estate-based improvements or strategic housing decisions.		Improved opportunities for resident engagement	N/A
26	Vulnerable residents	Conclude Phase Two of vulnerabilities work.	Tom Crawley / Kay Willman	Q4 2025-26	Without appropriate training, awareness (of policy and procedures) and support for tenants with additional needs, those tenants may be at risk of neglect or harm to safety.		New vulnerabilities procedure: all relevant staff trained; audit of vulnerabilities data	N/A
Transforming housing services								
27	Structure and services	Communicate to staff the outcomes of the regulatory inspection	Kay Willman	Q4 2024-25	Unmotivated staff impacting quality of service to tenants.		Staff able to understand the department's priorities	N/A
28	Structure and services	Restructure senior management to two director roles	Paul Chadwick	Q3 2025-26	Lack of clarity on responsibilities		Greater ownership of services to tenants focusing all activities under the Director of Housing Management	N/A
29	Structure and services	Appoint new senior management to lead the response to the regulatory inspection	Paul Chadwick	Q3 2025-26	Lack of urgency to respond to regulatory judgement		Director of Housing Management appointed and engaging with staff, tenants, councillors, and the Regulator	N/A
30	Structure and services	Review of Business Support and Finance functions	Michael Hallick/Paul Chadwick	Q2 2026-27	Poor responses to inquiries and complaints		Merged structure in place	N/A
31	Structure and services	Restructure of Housing	Bob Granville/Paul Chadwick	Q2 2027-28	General		Completely revised structure in place July 2027 completion via a sensibly phased series of divisional restructures	N/A

Ref	Topic	Required action/s	Officer lead(s)	Completion date	Risks to tenants if action not fulfilled	BRAG	Outputs	Target
32	Technology	Review and improve the use of data and technology to inform services to tenants	Sandra Burree	Q2 2026-27	Inefficient ways of working which impact service delivery to tenants and prevent self-service		Provide opportunities for tenants to self-serve and when not possible, to make systems efficient and effective	N/A

Appendix Two

ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

Executive summary

In response to receiving a C3 regulatory judgement, Wandsworth Council undertook a comprehensive Root Cause Analysis (RCA) to identify the underlying factors contributing to service failings within its housing services. This reflective exercise, led by senior management and supported by an external consultant, aimed to ensure that robust mitigations are in place to prevent recurrence and to support both regulatory compliance and long-term service transformation.

The RCA identified four key themes: the position of the department (and its relationship with the wider organisation), departmental culture, data and systems, and performance management. Historically, the Housing department operated with limited corporate oversight, leading to siloed practices and insufficient scrutiny of critical areas such as stock condition and building safety. Cultural challenges, including slow responsiveness to change and a reluctance to act on benchmarking, further hindered service improvement. A performance culture was not pervasive across the department, despite evidence of good practice within some sections.

To address these issues, the Council has implemented a new governance framework, restructured its housing services into a broader Resident Services directorate, and initiated a full review of the repairs process. Efforts are also underway to improve data quality and accessibility through system integration and clearer data ownership. A renewed focus on performance management, resident engagement, and contract oversight is central to driving sustainable improvements.

This RCA has directly informed the Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan and is a key step in strengthening the Council's ability to deliver safe, responsive, and resident-focused housing services. Enhanced governance and oversight, cultural change and a commitment to continuous improvement will ensure that Wandsworth is better positioned to meet regulatory standards and the expectations of its residents.

Why Wandsworth has undertaken a Root Cause Analysis (RCA)

Wandsworth Council undertook an RCA to identify the reasons for failings in its most recent regulatory inspection and to implement measures that not only address these issues but meet our broader ambitions of making Wandsworth a fairer, compassionate and more sustainable borough.

This exercise was led by senior management with input and fresh ideas being provided from an external consultant. The RCA identified four themes, each of these consisting of different challenges. These are:

- Position of Housing
- Departmental culture
- Data and systems
- Performance

Mitigations have been identified and agreed. These include short-, medium- and long-term measures to ensure continuous improvements to services that residents receive. The analysis will also inform the changes required both to ensure an improved satisfactory regulatory judgement and the wider, transformation goals for its housing services.

A Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan was developed in partnership with Housing and corporate colleagues. Appendix A illustrates the root causes identified within this analysis, linking to long term outcomes the Council is looking to achieve.

Senior managers reviewed a broad range of data and insights and whilst the foundation for this was the regulatory judgement, it was also an opportunity to address historical challenges faced within the department.

Position of Housing

The previous Housing Department encompassed Housing Management and Housing Services sections, Strategy, Compliance and Enabling and Regeneration sections. This included over 600 staff members responsible for providing services for over 33,000 tenants and leaseholders. The Housing Department historically operated at a distance from corporate oversight, resulting in limited strategic accountability and siloed working. This has led to gaps in understanding among senior leaders and elected members, particularly around critical issues such as stock condition.

Whilst scrutiny of housing delivery has increased since 2024, particularly considering Wandsworth's Tenant Satisfaction Measure performance, there remains greater opportunity for scrutiny from senior managers with senior (named) officers accountable for delivery against their respective areas. For example, in relation to electrical testing and other health and safety measures, these areas did not receive a sufficient level of scrutiny from outside the department, although this data is now reported as a quarterly corporate measure.

Since the inspection, a new governance framework has been established. This includes oversight from the Chief Executive and Senior Leadership Team, a dedicated Housing Improvement Programme Board, chaired by the Executive Director of Resident Services, and an expanded range of performance measures shared with senior leaders and councillors. The newly agreed measures reflect the actions required to provide the Regulator of Social Housing with assurance that it is delivering each of the four consumer standards. They also incorporate longer-term commitments that are included within the Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan.

Member oversight of the department is also supported by a dedicated Task and Finish group. The group has cross-party membership and convenes monthly to review performance, service delivery and key issues for thematic areas (for example, repairs improvements, stock condition and more). The meetings are also attended by a range of senior officers. There is also a detailed, annual presentation of

Wandsworth's Tenant Satisfaction Measures (TSMs). The TSMs presentation highlights areas of underperformance, benchmarking against other landlords and areas of focus with required actions.

It was also acknowledged that an internal departmental focus limited the opportunity to learn from good practice from other services. To address this, the Council has restructured the department and merged with Environment and Community Services to create one, delivery-focused 'Resident Services' directorate. This provides greater opportunities for collaboration and broader learning about approaches. By promoting a culture of learning and collaboration, within its housing and place-based teams, it is expected that service delivery will improve and tenant satisfaction will increase. In addition, it is an opportunity for those services that are performing strongly and helping achieve high levels of satisfaction to showcase their work. Equally, this is an opportunity to build on collaboration beyond housing.

Departmental Culture

Departmental culture and practices were identified as areas requiring change to support long-term service improvement. Some entrenched behaviours and structural issues have limited the department's ability to adapt, innovate, and respond effectively to resident needs and regulatory expectations. Where previous recommendations or plans of action have been prepared, changes were not implemented swiftly. By encouraging behavioural change, housing teams will be better placed to meet the diverse needs of residents.

For example, this meant that in some areas, processes remained in place that other landlords had since moved away from. This led to established ways of working that were not necessarily achieving high quality outputs for residents. Whilst benchmarking was regularly undertaken to better understand best practice within the sector, findings were not always acted upon. For example, in the areas of recording repairs and creating opportunities for resident engagement, traditional models remained in place.

It is important to note that the Council was a founder member of the Association of Retained Council Housing (ARCH) and regularly participated in London Councils meetings. We are strengthening this experience by learning from other councils, for example, this has included engaging with other local authorities, specifically Camden and Enfield. Acting on learning is crucial to the ongoing development of the service. A full review of the repairs process is underway, supported by the Council's internal Delivery Unit and external consultants Roretti. The repairs review is informed by resident insight from focus groups as well as comparative performance data and learning from other providers. The review will conclude in December 2025 and aims to transform the resident repairs journey.

A reactive approach to building safety prioritising short-term fixes over strategic long-term investment was also identified. To address this, the Housing Improvement Programme Board is looking at structures for a more robust and better resourced

Building Safety team to ensure a long-term, risk-based approach to safety and compliance in the management of our stock.

Customer focus has been highlighted as an issue when delivering services. This stems from increasing demands being placed on frontline-staff, such as Estate Managers, without a sufficiently detailed review by senior management of their capacity to fulfil these roles effectively with the increased workload. Consequently, frontline officers have become more reactive than proactive in addressing residents' needs, leading to a diminished focus on customer service which has impacted residents' perception of the Council's management of its housing stock.

Efforts are being undertaken to encourage a greater customer focus by designing services around the diverse needs of residents. This is being tackled through increased resident involvement in service design and scrutiny, supported by better use of data and insight and making important reasonable adjustments for those who require them. The focus groups held in March and April 2025 gave useful insight into experiences of those who were dissatisfied with repairs or complaints.

Other cultural challenges include slow responses to legislative change and a tendency to rely on operational experience rather than strategic planning. These are being addressed through improved governance, broader engagement with staff and members and a shift towards co-produced services that reflect the lived experiences of residents.

The Council acknowledged that decision-making was centralised; limited to a core team of directors. This is being addressed through the Decision Making and Accountability programme which will ultimately create a flatter management structure with fewer hierarchies. Equally, the move to Resident Services has created a broader leadership group. There will be greater opportunities for staff to identify or suggest areas for improvement, through increased engagement and by promoting psychological safety within teams. This will be complemented by increased collaboration across the organisation.

Data and systems

As a large department encompassing many services, different teams have developed their own methods of recording and maintaining data. This presents challenges when trying to source key data for improving services or monitoring delivery. Whilst tenancy and property information is held on NEC and fire safety functions (e.g. front door inspections and fire risk assessments) are on RiskBase, a number of services were found to be using spreadsheets for the storing of data. This presents a challenge when trying to access data in a timely manner particularly if there are limited data owners involved. To ameliorate this, the Council is developing a single source of truth using its NEC and RiskBase platforms. This will involve a data mapping exercise to clearly identify data owners – service leads ultimately responsible for signing off data and performance information at a local level. This will be complemented by ongoing campaigns to encourage staff engagement with

the applications. Many services manage data by using dashboards. These will give a real-time view on the current performance and challenges

The key risk associated with data inconsistencies is not having important and up to date information on the safety and condition of tenants' homes. Whilst the Council was confident that its approach to data management did not compromise the safety of residents, it was agreed that accessing information in a timely manner was challenging. By moving towards universal - rather than local - systems, data harmonisation will make it easier for detailed analysis to be undertaken and, subsequently, for this to inform key decisions. A Task and Finish Group has recently been established and will lead on overseeing this work, including, improving the quality of datasets used.

It was also evident that functionality of the NEC system could be utilised further. There is capability for additional resources to be used which could aid the repairs process and increase overall efficiency. These will be explored in more detail through the repairs review that is currently taking place. Officers involved in the repairs review have already liaised with other local authorities to identify how they are using their systems for recording repairs.

Data and insight are now being used in a series of meetings with senior leaders, monthly meetings with the Chief Executive and Senior Leadership Team have been established. In addition, there is regular engagement with the Cabinet Member for Housing and representatives from the Regulator of Social Housing. These steps aim to increase scrutiny, accountability, and early identification of risks ensuring that decisions are taken making the best use of data and insight.

Performance

Performance information is at the heart of shaping and improving services. For example, where satisfaction levels are low or services underperform against sectoral benchmarks, action is taken. This has led to improvements in key areas such as complaints handling and repairs. This analysis however has identified that a performance culture should be embedded across all teams. Consequently, it is expected that negative trends or underperformance can be acted upon more swiftly. Addressing worsening performance, in the relevant forums, with senior officers is a key component to driving improvements. Greater ownership of performance was also identified as a challenge in some areas of the department. Residents have a right to know how well their services are being provided and how contracts are being managed.

Since the inspection, there has been an increased use of performance data to inform service delivery. As mentioned earlier in this report, new governance arrangements are in place, with performance data a central component of these discussions. The improvement plan has lead officers (or owners) named, increasing accountability. Performance information includes risks and finance information, whereby if a budgetary pressure is identified, it can be acted upon. These changes will make it easier for failures to be addressed and a requisite level of support provided.

As mentioned earlier in this report, regular benchmarking was undertaken across the sector. The grounds for improvement are acting upon this insight and providing a greater role for strategy and research to drive improvements. The Council is now proactively using comparative TSM data and benchmarking for nearby and comparable sized landlords.

To ensure that performance is not simply a review of benchmarks and other comparable data, it is essential that the resident voice is also fundamental to this. Since the inspection, there has been greater use of findings from perception surveys: focus groups with residents have been established to better understand concerns of residents. Residents' views will shape the improvements that need to be made. With an increasing number of engaged tenants and leaseholders on the Participation Register¹, this demonstrates the appetite within the community to work in partnership. In addition, opportunities for deeper understanding of issues will be explored, for example, by developing more focused transactional surveys.

As with most large landlords, a considerable number of contracts are in place. It was acknowledged that greater grip on contract management should be applied universally. This could mean developing a contract management toolkit so that there is an agreed understanding of when and how interventions should be made (with increased meetings if required). This means that contractors will be expected to deliver a high-quality service and clearly state why they have not been able to achieve agreed outcomes. Greater opportunities for residents to be involved in procurement and management of contracts will also be explored.

Conclusion

The RCA has identified areas which contributed towards the Regulator's C3 rating following its inspection. This has served to inform a series of improvements that will put Wandsworth in a stronger position ahead of a future inspection. The analysis links to the Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan and with improved governance in place, it is expected that changes to practices and greater oversight of delivery, the Council can deliver an improved housing service, better positioned to meet the needs of residents.

¹ The Participation Register is a list of tenants and leaseholders who have signed up for participation and engagement activities. The current (Nov 2025) membership is >700 residents.

Appendix Three



Tenant Satisfaction Measures: 2024/2025 summary and comparison

Date: 7 January 2026

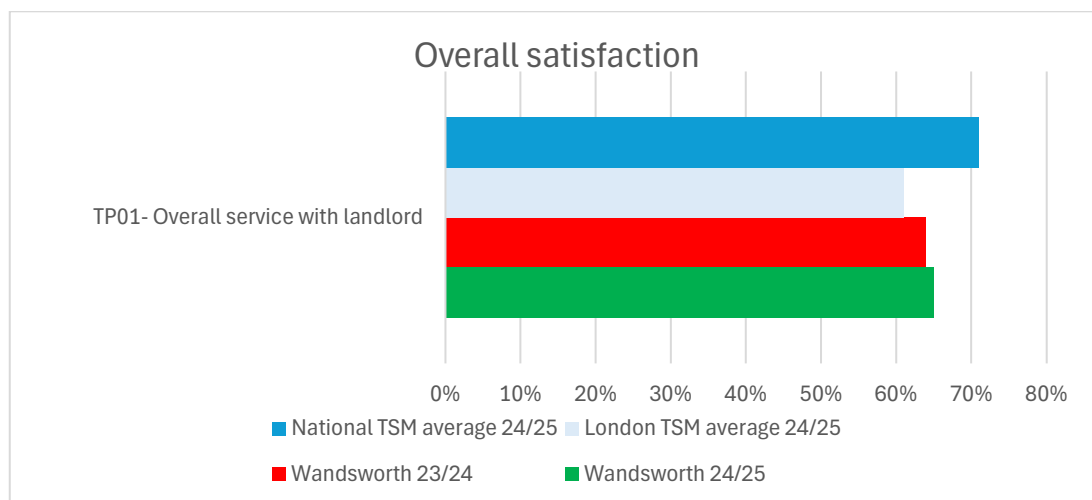
1. Executive Summary

- 1.1. The Regulator of Social Housing, as part of its approach to regulation, introduced a suite of performance indicators, known as Tenant Satisfaction Measures (TSMs) in April 2023. These are collected and submitted annually, with a nationwide dataset made available in November 2025.
- 1.2. This report details the 2024/2025 TSM submission in the context of the national and London averages.
- 1.3. There have been incremental improvements in overall satisfaction and satisfaction with the repairs service. Wandsworth compares well in health and safety-related TSMs but complaints and anti-social behaviour case volumes remain low compared to other landlords.

2. Details

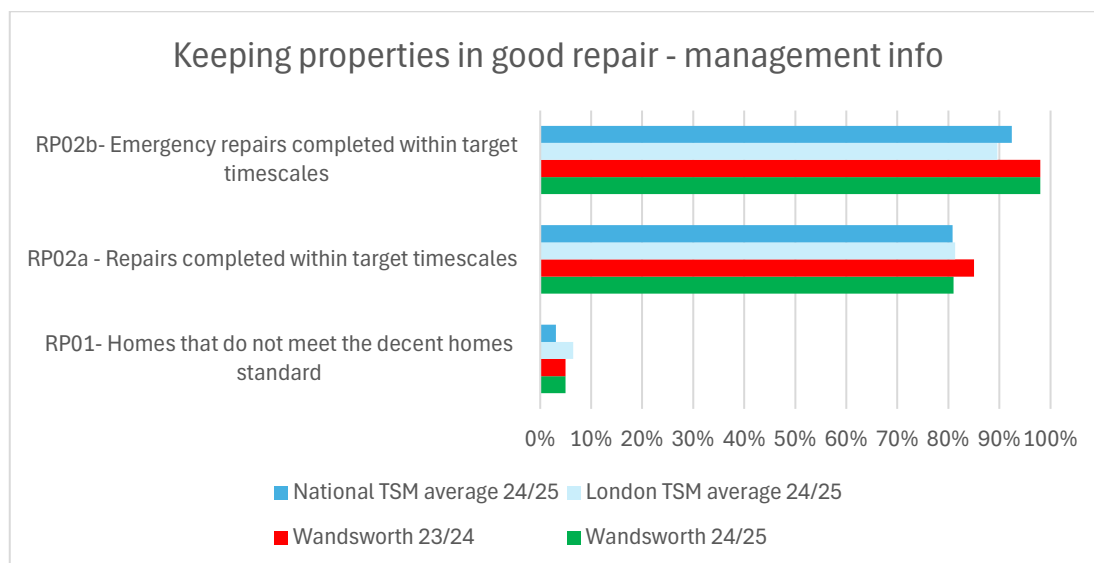
- 2.1. As part of their approach to consumer regulation, the Regulator of Social Housing (RSH) developed a suite of 22 performance indicators, known as Tenant Satisfaction Measures (TSMs). The aims were to both let tenants know how well their landlord is doing and to provide the Regulator with information on which landlords require improvement. These are collated for the April to March reporting period and split between tenant perception measures and management information measures. In November 2025, the full dataset for all registered social landlords was released.
- 2.2. This report details Wandsworth's 2024/2025 TSM submission in the context of the national and London averages.

- 2.3. In addition to overall satisfaction, the TSMs are grouped and presented within five themes – keeping properties in good repair, maintaining building safety, respectful and helpful engagement, effective handling of complaints and responsible neighbourhood management. The Resident's Annual Report, published in October details the priorities and actions delivered throughout the year (for both tenants and leaseholders) to achieve the performance under each theme.
- 2.4. For the tenant perception measures, face-to-face interviews were carried out in July and August 2024, with a sample size of 1,065 and weighted by tenure, age, status, gender and property type. For 2026/27, the methodology will be changed to monthly telephone surveys. This will enable satisfaction to be collated throughout the year so when improvements and changes are made to services real time feedback can be gathered on the impact for tenants.
- 2.5. Data from the tenant satisfaction measures and the perception survey are used throughout the year to inform service planning and strategy, for example the Housing Improvement and Transformation Plan. Resident focus groups have been arranged to consider areas of low performance, such as the repairs and complaints focus groups.
- 2.6. Overall satisfaction
- Overall tenant satisfaction remained stable with a slight increase to 65% this year from 64% in 2024.
 - This is higher than the London average increase (61%) both lower than national (71%).
 - Females (62%) were less satisfied overall than males (70%). Households with disabilities reported lower satisfaction (60%) than households without disabilities present (71%)
 - The top three reasons for overall dissatisfaction were issues with repairs (42% of respondents who were dissatisfied), slow response or action (11%) and issues with damp and mould (9%).

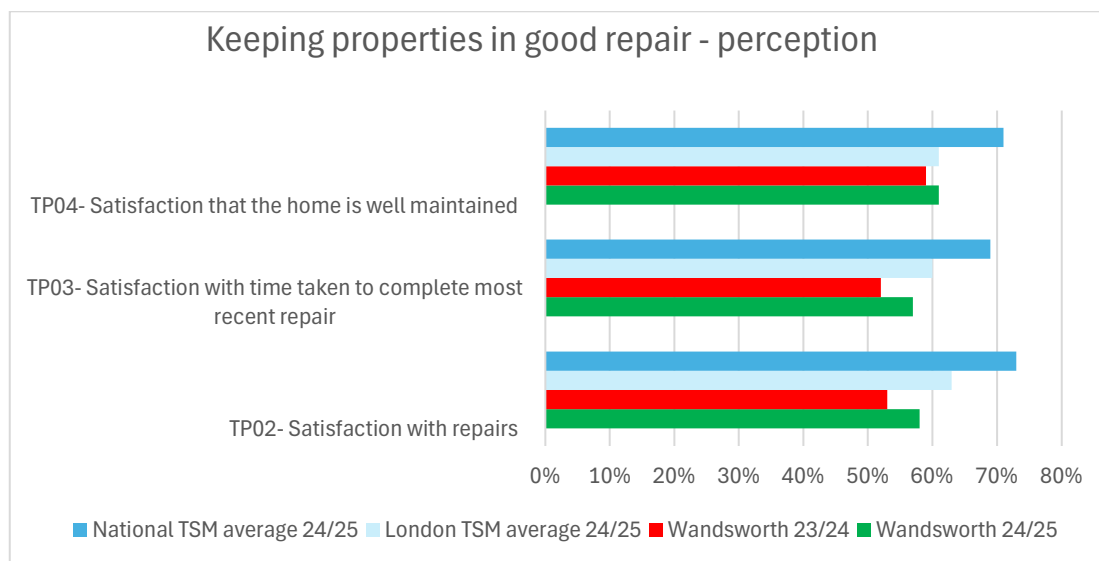


2.7. Keeping properties in good repair

- Although lower than last year (85%), the percentage of non-emergency repairs completed on time (81%) is identical to the national and London average.
- 98% of emergency repairs were completed in target. No change from 23/24 and higher than the national (92%) and London (90%) average.
- The proportion of homes that do not meet the decent homes standard remains the same at 5%, higher than nationally (3%) but lower than London (7%). An accelerated stock condition programme is currently underway, and every tenanted home and block will have a survey by the end of 2026. This will inform a greater understanding of our stock. From December 2026, 20% of stock will be surveyed on an annual basis.

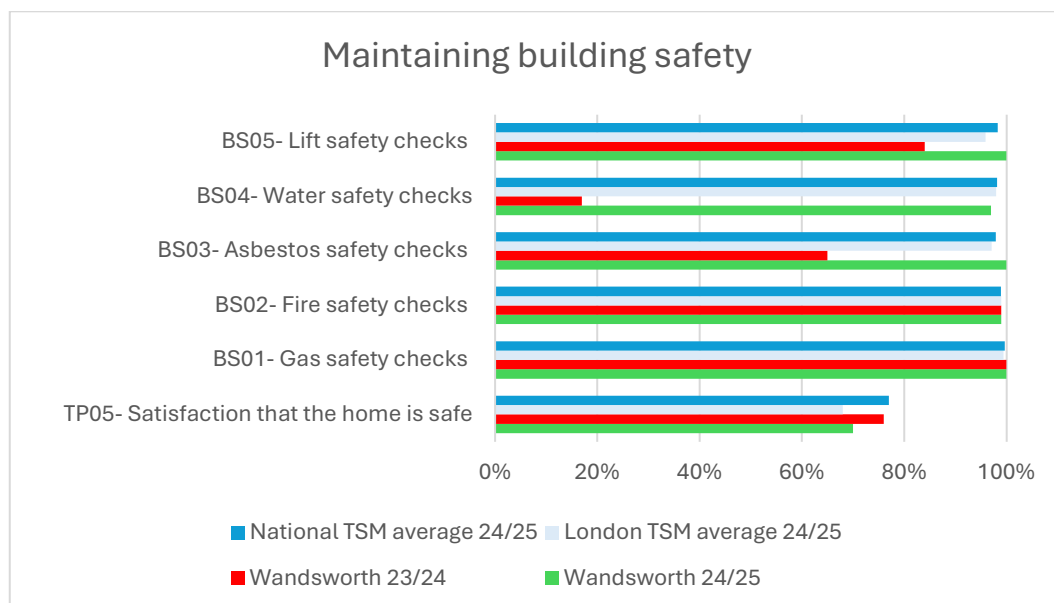


- Tenant satisfaction with the repairs service has improved year-on-year (53% to 58%), but overall, is lower than the national (73%) and London (63%) averages and in the lowest quartile for both.
- Satisfaction with the time taken to complete a repair has also increased (52% to 57%) but remains lower than average.
- Satisfaction that the home is well maintained has increased from 59% to 61%, comparing well to London (61%) but lower than the national average (71%).
- Since the publication of these results, a focus group has been held with residents to gain further insights into their experience of repairs.
- Work is concluding with the Delivery Unit to review how the repairs service is delivered with early findings and recommendations being provided to members in mid-January 2026.



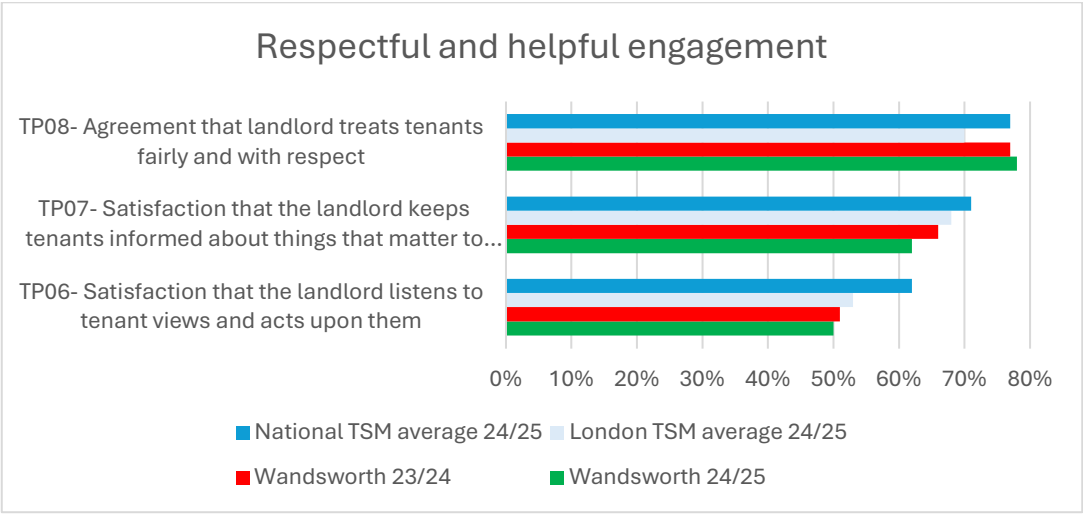
2.8. Maintaining building safety

- 70% of tenants are satisfied that their home is safe, above the London average (68%). However, this is a drop from 77% last year.
- Water, lift and asbestos safety checks has been addressed this year and have shown notable improvement with over 97% of checks completed.
- Gas safety checks and fire safety checks at 99%, remaining steady from previous years.



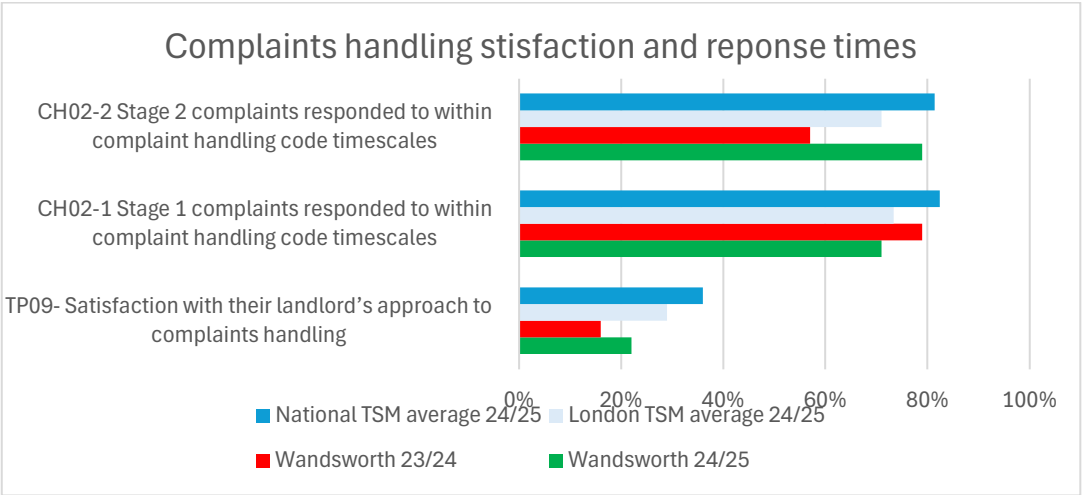
2.9. Respectful and helpful engagement

- Under the resident engagement theme, the highest satisfaction levels were reflected in treating tenants fairly and with respect (78%). This is higher than the national (77%) and London (70%) average.
- However, at 50%, satisfaction that tenants' views are listened to and acted on is lower than the national (62%) and London (53%) average. These figures will inform future work on improving our engagement with tenants including an external audit of engagement methods.
- Satisfaction with keeping residents informed is also lower (62%) than the national (71%) and London (68%) average and lower than the previous year (66%).

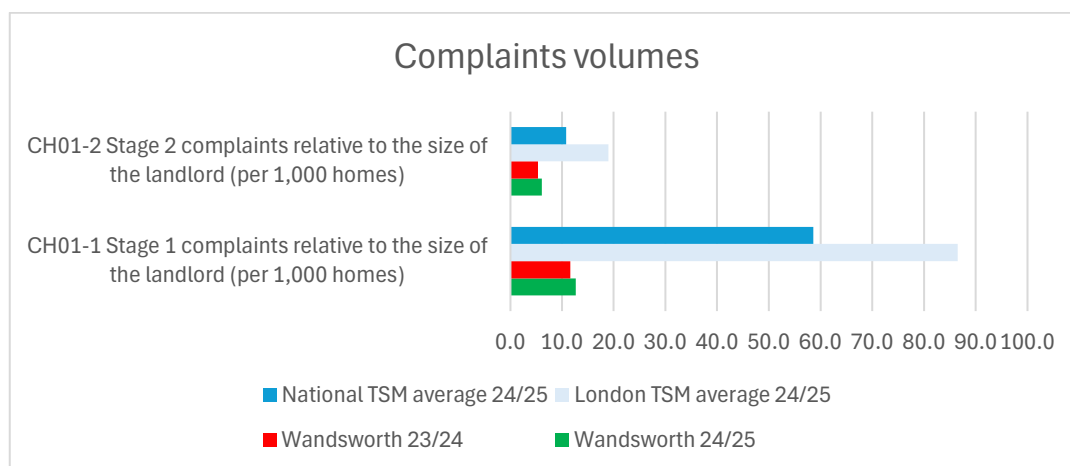


2.10. Complaints handling

- Satisfaction with complaints handling remains low at 22%. However, this is an increase from 16% in the previous year. This is lower than the London (29%) and National (36%) average. An action plan is in place to ensure full compliance with Housing Ombudsman complaint handling standards.
- The percentage of stage one complaints responded to on time has fallen from 79% last year to 71%. This is close to the London average of 73%, despite a lower average volume of cases.
- However, there was a positive increase in the proportion of stage two complaints responded to on time, from 57% to 79%.

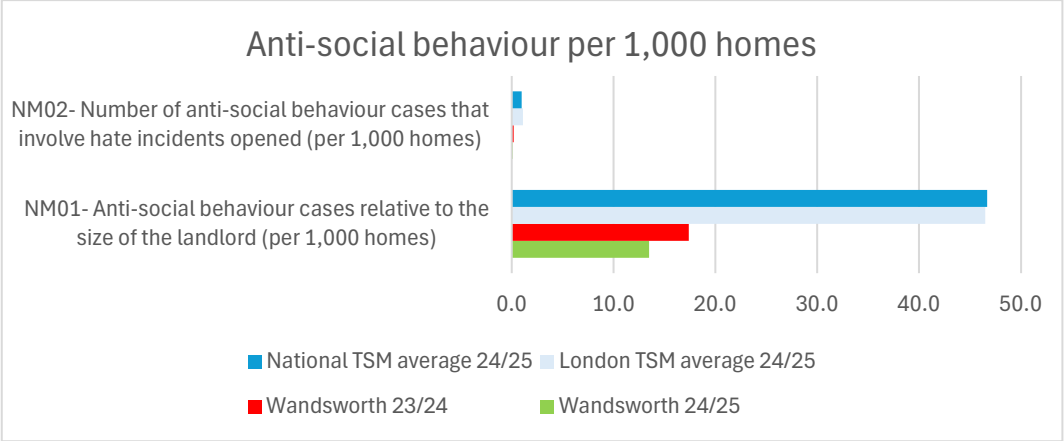


- At 12.7 complaints per 1,000 homes, Wandsworth records significantly fewer stage one complaints compared to the national (58.6 cases per 1000 homes) and London (86.5 cases per 1,000 homes) average.
- For stage two complaints, the difference is smaller but still low (6.1 per 1,000 homes) compared to the national average (10.8 per 1,000 homes) and London average (19.0 per 1,000 homes).
- Work is well underway to review the monitoring and logging of complaints. There are also regular reviews of live complaints to ensure that lessons are learned.

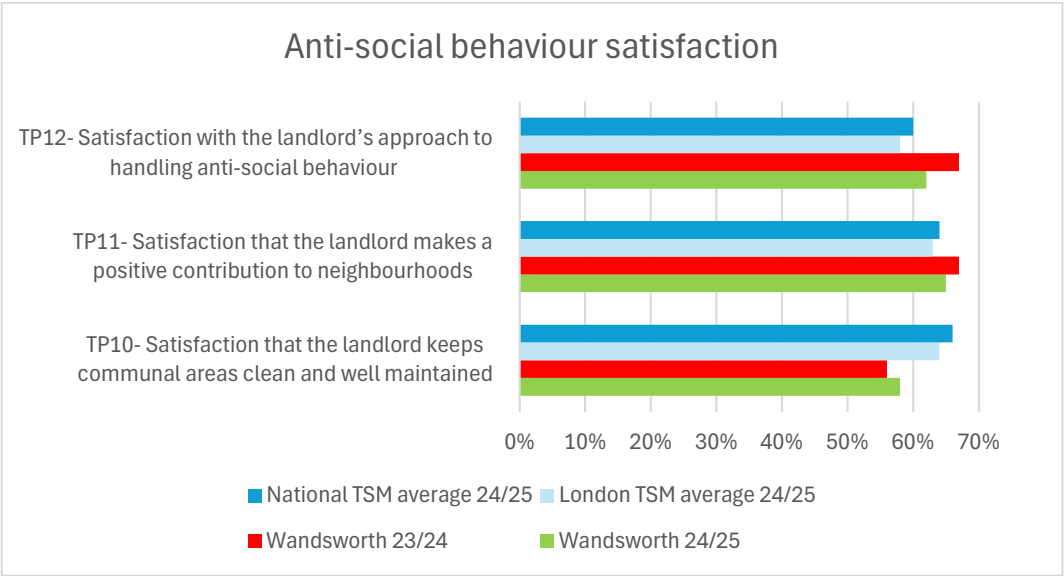


2.11. Responsible neighbourhood management

- The volume of ASB cases received or logged remains low at 13.5 cases per 1,000 homes and has decreased from last year (17.4 cases per 1,000 homes). This is much lower than the national (46.7 cases per 1,000 homes) and London (46.5 cases per 1,000 homes) average.
- The volume of hate incidents also remains low (0.1 cases per 1,000 homes compared to 0.2 cases per 1,000 homes last year) and is significantly lower than the national (1.0 cases per 1,000 homes) and London (1.1 cases per 1,000 homes) averages.
- Through the review of the ASB Policy in 2026, work will be undertaken to ensure correct recording of cases.



- Satisfaction with handling ASB has fallen from last year (62% from 67%) but is higher than the national (60%) and London (58%) average.
- Satisfaction that the landlord makes a positive contribution to neighbourhoods has also fallen slightly (65% from 67%). Although this still remains higher than the national (64%) and London (63%) averages.
- 58% are satisfied that communal areas are kept clean and well maintained. This is lower than London (64%) and nationally (66%).



3. **Conclusion**

- 3.1 Wandsworth's 2024/2025 Tenant Satisfaction Measures indicate stable overall satisfaction, with notable strengths in treating tenants respectfully and significantly improved safety compliance. However, satisfaction with repairs and complaints handling were below national averages, prompting a series of targeted improvement actions. Key engagement areas - such as listening to and acting upon tenants' views and keeping them informed - also recorded lower-than-average performance.
- 3.2 Complaints and anti-social behaviour case volumes remain low, leading to ongoing reviews to ensure accurate recording. Looking ahead, the planned shift to monthly surveys in 2026/27 will deliver more timely feedback, supporting efforts to raise satisfaction levels and close gaps against national and London benchmarks.